> The Soviet Union had also agreed to construct a compressor project in Khwaja Gogardak. The total cost of these two projects was estimated to be twenty million Russian rubles.

On 12 June 1979, when Indian Prime Minister Chaudhary Charan Singh was in Moscow, Soviet President Leonid Brezhnev expressed his concern about Pakistan's growing interference in Afghanistan. In a closed-door meeting with Charan Singh, Brezhnev made it clear that the Soviet Union had no desire to leave Afghanistan to fend for itself.

This alarmed the R&AW spies who, one month later, found President Taraki's tone towards Pakistan a bit aggressive. Visiting Farah and Nimroz provinces on 19 July 1979, Taraki said that Pakistan was doing the dangerous act of interfering in Afghanistan's internal affairs, which in fact meant playing with fire that would burn not only Pakistan and Iran but also 'Put to flames all the world'.

'We have no choice if war is forced on us,' Taraki said. This statement was followed by a direct attack by Amin on Saudi Arabia, the USA, China and Iran for arming Afghan refugees who had taken shelter in Pakistan.

Vodka and a Coup

Reddy told me that people in Afghanistan hear the truth only if it is shouted from the top: 'Whatever is being said is true because only truth can be so loud.'

The truth was positively deafening on President Taraki's birthday. A July 1979 intelligence dispatch sent to New Delhi revealed that a special Russian vodka labeled 'Long Live Soviet-Afghan Friendship' had been served at the reception to